

Sam Sharman

Texas A&M University
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EMPLOYMENT

INTERNATIONAL UNIVERSITY OF JAPAN

Assistant Professor of Political Science, Graduate School of International Relations
(Starting September 2026)

EDUCATION

TEXAS A&M UNIVERSITY

Ph.D. in Political Science, 2026
Dissertation: Political Succession and International Political Economy
Committee: José Antonio Cheibub (chair), Quan Li (co-chair), Scott J. Cook, and David Bearce

GEORGIA STATE UNIVERSITY

M.A. in Political Science, 2020
B.A. in Political Science, 2019

PUBLICATIONS

Sharman, Sam. 2024. "Labor Mobility and Semi-Presidentialism." *Electoral Studies* 88 (April): 102772.

WORKING PAPERS

Goidel, Spencer, Leon Kockaya, and Sam Sharman. "Surveil Thy Neighbor: Priming Policy Preferences and Support for State Surveillance." (revise & resubmit at *Journal of Politics*)

Sharman, Sam. "Succession from Strength: Coups and Autocratic Succession Rules in Sub-Saharan Africa." (under review)

Sharman, Sam. "Succession, Stability, and Sovereign Bonds in Sub-Saharan Africa." (under review)

Choi, Hongbi, and Sam Sharman. "The Conditional Importance of the Rule of Law for Foreign Direct Investment in Autocracies."

Kockaya, Leon, and Sam Sharman. "The Mortality Dividend: Leader Deaths and Market Reactions."

Young, Clifford, Kirby Goidel, and Sam Sharman. "Beyond Authoritarian Populism: Testing Nativism As the Primary Driver of Contemporary Politics."

WORKS IN PROGRESS

Sharman, Sam. "Succession Rules and the Survival of Autocratic Regimes."

Chi, Erik, Nathan McCoslin, and Sam Sharman. "Microfoundations of Costless Credible Signaling."

Kockaya, Leon, and Sam Sharman. "Announcing Fixed Exchange Rate Regimes: Why States Lie about Floating."

Ray, Nicholas, and Sam Sharman. "Observing Costly Signaling."

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Young, Clifford, Kirby Goidel, and Sam Sharman. "Beyond Authoritarian Populism: Testing Nativism As the Primary Driver of Contemporary Politics." Paper accepted for the Annual Meeting of the American Association of Public Opinion Researchers, Los Angeles, CA, May 13–15.

Kockaya, Leon, and Sam Sharman. 2026. "The Mortality Dividend: Leader Deaths and Market Reactions." Paper accepted for the Annual Meeting of the Midwestern Political Science Association, Chicago, IL, April 23–26.

Choi, Hongbi, and Sam Sharman. 2025. "The Conditional Importance of the Rule of Law for Foreign Direct Investment in Autocracies." Poster presented at the Annual Meeting of the International Political Economy Society, Los Angeles, CA, October 17–18.

Choi, Hongbi, and Sam Sharman. 2025. "The Conditional Importance of the Rule of Law for Foreign Direct Investment in Autocracies." Presented at the Annual Meeting of the Midwestern Political Science Association, Chicago, IL, April 3–6.

Sharman, Sam. 2024. "Succession Rules and the Survival of Autocratic Regimes." Presented at the Annual Meeting of the American Political Science Association, Philadelphia, PA, September 5–8.

Sharman, Sam. 2024. "Autocratic Succession and Access to Foreign Finance." Presented at the Annual Meeting of the Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago, IL, April 4–7.

Kockaya, Leon, and Sam Sharman. 2024. "Building on Democratic Hypocrisy: State Power and Surveillance." Presented at the Annual Meeting of the Southern Political Science Association, New Orleans, LA, January 10–13.

Sharman, Sam. 2023. "Autocratic Succession and Access to Foreign Finance." Presented at the Annual Meeting of the International Political Economy Society, Washington, DC, October 28–29.

Sharman, Sam. 2023. "Autocratic Survival and the Introduction of Succession Rules." Presented at the Annual Meeting of the Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago, IL, April 13–16.

Sharman, Sam. 2022. "Labor Mobility and Types of Democracy: Considering Semi-Presidentialism." Presented at the Southern Political Science Association Virtual Summer Meeting, June 16–17.

TEACHING

International University of Japan

- African Politics (graduate) (Fall 2026)
- Comparative Political Economy (graduate) (Winter 2027)
- Political Analysis (graduate) (Spring 2027)

Texas A&M University

Instructor of Record

- INTA 606: International Politics in Theory and Practice (graduate) (Fall 2025)
- POLS 424: Comparative Governmental Institutions (Fall 2024, Spring 2025, Spring 2026)
- POLS 318: Theories of International Relations (Fall 2025)

Teaching Assistant

- POLS 606: Causal Inference (graduate) (Fall 2023, Hannah Simpson)
- POLS 603: Quantitative Political Analysis II (graduate) (Spring 2023, Scott J. Cook)
- POLS 602: Quantitative Political Analysis I (graduate) (Fall 2022, Paul Kellstedt)
- POLS 309: Polimetrics (Fall 2021, Alicia Cooperman; Spring 2022, Casey Crisman-Cox)
- POLS 209: Introduction to Political Science Research (Fall 2020, Carlo Horz; Spring 2024, Ali Kagalwala)
- POLS 200: Foundations of Political Science (Spring 2021, José Antonio Cheibub)

DEPARTMENT SERVICE

Texas A&M University

President of the Political Science Graduate Student Association, 2023–2024
Graduate Student Mentor, 2023–2025

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

American Political Science Association
International Political Economy Society
International Studies Association
Midwest Political Science Association
Southern Political Science Association